

SANGJUN (SAMUEL) Ko

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EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
Bachelor of Science in Statistics (CGPA: 3.93/4.00)

- Mathematics Minor

Champaign, Illinois
January 2023 - May 2025

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staffmark Group (on assignment at Kimberly-Clark)
Statistician

Neenah, Wisconsin
June 2025 - Present

- Built and deployed leakageReport, a Flask-based statistical reporting module that replaced an outdated legacy system for mannequin leakage studies—now used by technicians to generate mixed-model ANOVA/pairwise-comparison reports for stakeholders and researchers
- Built and deployed 5 additional Python modules on an internal analytics platform, including a Python port of an Excel/VBA X-ray absorbency analysis, two predictive-modeling UIs for R&D teams, and a mannequin database/intake tool now owned by a teammate
- Lead or support 10+ concurrent Test Method Validation (TMV) and Gauge R&R studies (basis weight, tensile, caliper, tear strength, attribute inspection) across product lines, translating bias/precision results into pass/fail recommendations and spec-limit proposals
- Deliver ~45 individually-requested mannequin leakage analyses/year (~6/month); support DOE design for a Youth TMD screening method projected to save the business unit millions by replacing multi-month consumer home-use tests

STAT107 Data Science Discovery
Undergraduate Course Assistant

Champaign, Illinois
August 2023 - May 2025

- Assisted over 300 students with fundamental data science concepts through interactive labs
- Managed Git for learning platform modifications, benefiting 1000+ students; create, edit, and proofread course materials

Applied Technologies for Learning in Arts & Sciences
AI/ML Intern Team Leader

Champaign, Illinois
January 2024 - December 2024

- Lead a team of 5 interns and collaborated closely with 3 managers in weekly meetings
- Built ML models with 100,000+ data points using Python and advanced techniques like XGBoost and BERT

PROJECTS/AWARDS

Graduation Prediction Model

- Increased AUC score from 0.65 to 0.82 by reducing noise in the dataset through feature engineering and outlier removal across 50,000+ student records
- Built a Streamlit interface with 12 key predictors for real-time predictions for university administrators

3rd Place, 2024 COVID Information Commons Student Paper Challenge (Columbia University)

- Analyzed the socioeconomic and mental health impacts of COVID-19 in Mexico, identifying that 42% of females and 40% of young adults faced job loss
- Proposed interventions to support vulnerable groups through geospatial and statistical analysis

Paraphrase Detection

- Achieved 90%+ accuracy in paraphrase detection using BERT, RoBERTa, and SBERT models on the MRPC dataset
- Developed a Gradio interface for real-time detection for easier evaluation of textual similarities

SKILLS

Languages: English (Fluent), Spanish (Native), Korean (Native), French (Basic), Chinese (Basic)
Computer: Python (Advanced): Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-learn, TensorFlow, NLTK, Matplotlib
R (Intermediate): Tidyverse, ggplot2, dplyr, caret
JMP (Intermediate), Excel/VBA (Intermediate), Git (Intermediate), SAS (Intermediate)
SQL (Basic), Tableau (Basic), Office (Advanced)
Certificates: Data Science Certificate, Coursera Business Analytics Certificate

COMMUNITY SERVICE AND EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Volunteer, Appleton Public Library
Consultant in Illinois Business Consulting

August 2025 - Present
September 2024 - December 2024